

Chinese
[t͡ɕʊŋwən]

github.com/cb-g/bhasa

February 28, 2026

1 Phonology

1.1 Vowels

i	close front unrounded vowel
u	close back rounded vowel
y	close front rounded vowel
a	open vowel
ə	mid central vowel (schwa)
ɜ	close-mid central unrounded vowel

1.2 Consonants

m	voiced bilabial nasal
n	voiced alveolar nasal
ɱ	voiced velar nasal
p	voiceless bilabial plosive (unaspirated)
p ^h	voiceless bilabial plosive (aspirated)
t	voiceless alveolar plosive (unaspirated)
t ^h	voiceless alveolar plosive (aspirated)
k	voiceless velar plosive (unaspirated)
k ^h	voiceless velar plosive (aspirated)
ts	voiceless alveolar affricate (unaspirated)
ts ^h	voiceless alveolar affricate (aspirated)
ʈ	voiceless retroflex affricate (unaspirated)
ʈ ^h	voiceless retroflex affricate (aspirated)
tʃ	voiceless alveolo-palatal affricate (unaspirated)
tʃ ^h	voiceless alveolo-palatal affricate (aspirated)
f	voiceless labiodental fricative
s	voiceless alveolar fricative
ʃ	voiceless retroflex fricative
ç	voiceless alveolo-palatal fricative
x h	voiceless velar/glottal fricative
l	voiced alveolar lateral approximant
ɭ, ɮ	voiced retroflex approximant
j	voiced palatal approximant
w	voiced labio-velar approximant

1.3 Tones

˥	tone 1 (high-level); endonym: jìn˥p ^{hi} y˥ or yīnpíng
˨˨˥	tone 2 (high-rising); endonym: jāŋ˥p ^{hi} y˥ or yángpíng
˨˨˨˥	tone 3 (low-rising); endonym: cən˨˨˥ or sāng
˨˨˨˨˥	tone 4 (high-falling); endonym: tɕ ^h y˨˨˥ or qù
(neutral)	neutral tone (weak syllables); endonym: tɕ ^h y˥cən˥ or qīngshēng

2 Glosses

- (1) woʌ ʃɿʌ tsiʌjouʌ
wǒ shì zìyóu
1SG be free

I am free.

- (2) niʌ ʃɿʌ woʌ dəʌ pəŋʌjouʌ
nǐ shì wǒ de péngyǒu
2SG be 1SG GEN friend

You are my friend.

- (3) woʌmən ɕjaŋʌ xwejʌ tɕjaʌ
wǒmen xiāng huí jiā
1PL want return home

We want to go home.

- (4) tʰaʌ laʌtɕʰiʌ tʰaʌ dəʌ ʃouʌ tʰaʌmən tʰjauʌwuʌ
tā lāqǐ tā de shǒu tāmen tiàowǔ
3SG.F take 3SG.M GEN hand 3PL dance

She takes his hand and they dance.

- (5) tʃənʌtʃəŋʌ dəʌ ɕiŋʌfuʌ lajʌtsiʌ xawʌɕyeʌ dəʌ ɕinʌ
zhēnzhèng de xìngfú láizì hàoxué de xīn
true GEN happiness come.from studious GEN mind

True happiness arises from a learning mind.